Knowledge organiser for causes and effects

Friday 22 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | GROW | Spring 1 Week 3 | HUM-GROW-S1-W03

Learning outcome: Explain causes and consequences of a protest movement.

In Montgomery, Alabama, USA, racist bus rules kept Black and White riders apart. Black residents and local groups had challenged unfair treatment for years. Rosa Parks was arrested on 1 December 1955. The boycott began on 5 December. Protest, shared work and a legal case all mattered.

Part	What to know
Long-term causes	Unfair bus rules; earlier requests brought little change.
Trigger	Parks's arrest on 1 December 1955 helped prompt the 5 December boycott.
During the boycott	Travel changed and fare income fell. Shared help sustained protest.
Legal process	Browder v. Gayle: district ruling 5 June 1956; upheld 13 November.
By the campaign's end	Order and boycott end on 20 December; return to buses 21 December 1956.
Later years	Links supported wider work; the campaign provided an example for later protest.

A change with limits

The boycott and a legal case worked alongside each other. Bus seating rights changed. Racism and unequal treatment did not end. One famous person did not act alone.

MIA means Montgomery Improvement Association. It helped lead the boycott.

Where this leads: historians and museum staff explain causes with evidence, not just a list of dates.